



GREY BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident	15 March 2024	Time of Incident	13:40
Directorate / Region	Goldfields Esperance	Main Roads or Contractor	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type	Incident – Lost Time	EQSafe Incident Number	38810
Actual Consequence	Moderate	Potential Consequence	Moderate

Incident Short Description	A Worker (Injured Person) fell from a standing position on the axle of the low loader to the ground
-----------------------------------	---

Executive Summary

On 15 March 2024 at approximately 13:40pm, a worker (Injured Person (IP) reversed a material handler (skid steer with slasher attachment) onto a low loader. The IP was attaching tie down straps and had placed their foot on top of the axle of the low loader and was trying to attach a tie down hook to the bucket arm. The IP's foot slipped on the axle end, and they fell approximately 300-400mm to the shoulder of the road, directly onto their hip.

IP then crawled under the truck to make sure they were clear of the road and made contact with their Supervisor. IP was taken to the hospital by ambulance. Currently, IP has no capacity for work until 26 April 2024.

Incident Photos



Slasher in position for strapping (note location of foot and hand positions)

Contributing Factors

- Safe Work Method Statement (SWMS) for work scope was not reviewed and approved for the site; risk control was not documented for the identified hazard 'fall from height and/or plant' with 'end of operation, pack up, and departure from site'.
- Personal risk assessment (Take 5) was not completed for the task; fall risk was not identified and controlled.
- Change management not applied with the engagement of subcontractor for work scope of clearing activities.
- Contractor management process not fully applied to subcontractor prior to the works commencing.
- The axle end used as a step to work at height was not a safety step.
- The Project Management team did not review the project risk register in light of the methodology change with clearing.
- Management of the change process was not applied in response to the decision to engage a subcontractor for work scope.
- The Project Supervisor was not trained on contractor management requirements.

Corrective Actions

- Document and establish a loading and unloading checklist for the completion of these works that incorporates the findings and required controls from this event investigation.
- Review subcontractor SWMS against requirements of the contractor's OFSC accreditation to ensure compliance with the project.
- Provide training to the Project Supervisor on contractor management requirements for the project.
- Raise requirements at pre-start for works to stop and incidents to be reported to the Project Manager immediately; the Project Manager is the only person authorised to allow the recommencement of works post-incident event.
- Implement contractor field leadership tools.
- Establish a schedule of one weekly inspection by PM, two Loss Prevention Inspections (LPIs) by the Project Supervisor and two safety interactions by each role.
- Obtain subcontractor mobilisation forms for all subcontractor personnel on the project and ensure all signatures are obtained with documentation.
- Log incident as emergency response exercise and debrief held.
- Implement subcontractor pre-qualification process for the project.
- Assign the Project Supervisor or delegate to follow up on daily pre-start paperwork for all registered plant and equipment on the project and ensure the generator is included.
- Establish plant register for project and follow up all documentation required for plant and equipment onsite; include upcoming preventative maintenance/service scheduling.
- Establish a training matrix for the project.
- Document and maintain training needs analysis for the project.
- Establish a change management register for the project to capture deviations from the tendered methodology and approach; ensure reviewed and approved by the client.
- Instruct all project personnel on the requirement to use the Take 5 process for task risk assessment purposes.
- Progress construction methodology from tender to project delivery and update to reflect changes made onsite; Project Supervisor to maintain as a 'live' document.

Additional Issues / Learnings

- Work at heights includes any potential fall situation.
- Ensure workers including subcontractors are aware of the importance of completing personal risk assessments prior to undertaking activities to ensure risks and hazards are identified, assessed, and controlled.
- Ensure subcontractor management processes are completed prior to new subcontractors commencing works to ensure adequate procedures and training have been undertaken.

**Critical Risks:**

This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk Profile relating to
'Fall from Height'

Distribution of Notice

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations